1. Ideation Phase

1.1 Project Title

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

1.2 Problem Statement

Organizations frequently receive IT incidents through emails, phone calls, and informal communication channels. When incidents are not managed through a structured system, several problems can occur, including incomplete incident information, incorrect classification, delayed assignment, poor visibility into resolution progress, SLA breaches, and difficulty in tracking recurring issues.

Manual incident handling also creates challenges when an issue requires collaboration between multiple support teams. Service Desk agents may need to involve Level 2 technical teams, create emergency changes, track related incidents, and document the final resolution. Without an integrated process, these activities can become fragmented.

Therefore, there is a need for a centralized and structured Incident Management process that supports the complete incident lifecycle from creation to resolution.

1.3 Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is to implement an **Incident Lifecycle Automation system using ServiceNow**.

The solution will use ServiceNow Incident Management capabilities to create, classify, assign, investigate, resolve, and track incidents. It will also integrate related ServiceNow capabilities such as Knowledge Management, Change Management, Configuration Management, Service Level Agreements, and Child Incidents.

The project will demonstrate an end-to-end incident lifecycle using a Corporate VPN connectivity issue as the primary scenario.

1.4 Project Vision

The vision of the project is to create a standardized incident management process that enables support teams to:

- Create and track incidents systematically.
- Classify incidents accurately.
- Associate incidents with services and configuration items.
- Use knowledge articles during troubleshooting.
- Reassign incidents to appropriate support teams.
- Track incidents through Level 2 investigation.
- Handle changes required for incident resolution.
- Create child incidents for related user issues.
- Document probable causes and resolution details.

- Generate knowledge articles from resolved incidents.
- Monitor SLA information and related records.

1.5 Business Value

The proposed solution can provide the following business benefits:

- **Faster incident resolution** through structured workflows and knowledge reuse.
- **Improved visibility** into incident status and ownership.
- **Better SLA compliance** through SLA tracking.
- **Improved collaboration** between Service Desk, Level 2, and Change Management teams.
- **Standardized incident classification** for better reporting and analysis.
- **Knowledge reuse** by converting successful resolutions into knowledge articles.
- **Centralized tracking** of parent and child incidents.
- **Better service management** through relationships between incidents, services, CIs, changes, and knowledge.

1.6 Project Scenario

The demonstration scenario is based on a user experiencing a **Corporate VPN authentication failure** while working from a home office.

The incident will progress through the following conceptual lifecycle:

Incident Creation → Classification → Knowledge Assistance → Reassignment → Level 2 Investigation → Change Handling → Child Incident Tracking → Resolution → Knowledge Creation → Validation

1.7 Expected Outcome

The expected outcome is a working ServiceNow Incident Management scenario demonstrating how an incident can move through multiple stages while maintaining related records, SLA information, knowledge, ownership, and resolution details.